

Editorial

Dear readers

So what makes for the perfect editorial? Should we talk about what we do, or should we focus more on what's happening around us?

That's the question we tossed around in a discussion on what qualified to feature in this column.

Those of you who've read my earlier pieces will probably wonder—why this question now? Doesn't he usually write about what's happening at *LINUX For You* or the EFY Group? Yes...guilty as charged. Yet, there's no time like *now* to question one's habits and try to improve.

Back to our discussion. We all agreed that the worst thing I could do was talk about the various stories in the magazine. That being the easiest route, we unanimously reserved it for the last resort. But, what if some of the topics featured happen to be related to our own initiatives? Well, that's a tricky one, which I guess boils down to assigning priorities to each subject—in itself a subjective exercise! The verdict? We decided that we could all pool in different topics that we felt were important, as individuals. And then collectively arrive at what truly constitutes 'top priority'.

And the winner for this month, as indicated by our cover, is the launch of linuxforu.com. It's important to us for many reasons. For starters, it is totally based on open source technology. Second, since we did the entire development ourselves, we have shared with you the whole process in the true spirit of open source. Third, we genuinely believe that this website can grow into a great platform—for the Indian Linux and Open Source industry and community to spread its wings. Besides, this website will ease the common problems our readers face in trying to access our earlier issues. We will be taking most of our content online after a month or two (more about this later).

Well, the very concept of throwing open our content is an experiment! Having taken the plunge, we'll then figure out how on earth we are going to survive—will our newsstand sales go down? Will anyone still pay for the print edition? Will India's only Linux and Open Source magazine die a slow death as it grows

into a portal instead, or will the magazine become even stronger? Frankly, we don't know the answers to these questions yet. In that sense, you are with us in this, and together we shall see how this experiment pans out.

Last, and this is important for us since our future depends on it...if we don't highlight such an important milestone in our history and invite your feedback and guidance, who will?

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So that's about what's happening at our end. In the world around us, Microsoft's Bing was launched. We'll be following that to see if this new entrant can carve some space for itself on Google's turf. HTC's launch of an Android phone is also eagerly awaited. Nimish Dubey, our mobile phone expert, has a treat lined up for you in the coming issue.

As always, we look forward to your views. Join our discussion on what makes for a great editorial! For starters, tell us if you feel linuxforu.com is important enough to be discussed here...

Best Wishes!



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